

“Everyone makes mistakes,” Joe said. “It’s good that you recognize your past faults, but you can’t afford to dwell on them. The past is history, and starting today you need to concentrate on building a better future. Your debt payments are going to be manageable, and you’ll be on solid ground within five years.”

“The problem is, this never would have happened to my mom and dad,” Naomi said. “They never got in over their heads, and they always paid their bills on time. I should have known better. We borrowed all that money in good faith, and now we’re not going to pay it all back.”

“That may be true, but remember—you’ll have a child to raise, and that child’s future will be much more secure as a result of what happened here today.”

“Yes,” Naomi replied. “But ...”

Ben broke in. “I agree with Joe. And I’ll say it again: I think this bankruptcy is an answer from God.”

“Of course,” responded Joe. “Even God provided a way to set aside debts so that His people wouldn’t be caught up in debts they couldn’t repay.”

“What do you mean?” Naomi asked.

“In the Old Testament God had a plan: every seven years all debts would be set aside. That’s where our bankruptcy laws originated.”

“I never heard anybody explain that before,” Ben said. “So God allows for bankruptcy too?”

“Absolutely,” replied Joe. “Otherwise I wouldn’t be in this business.”

As Ben and Naomi headed home she commented, “Ben, I’m still embarrassed about this bankruptcy, and I feel like we’re cheating our creditors.”

“I don’t,” Ben replied. “It feels like a burden has been lifted off our shoulders. We have a chance to start fresh and get our lives back in order, and pay back in a way that’s doable. Wait and see; things are going to work out from now on.”